

Call Prep: Ryan Menke — OFS Brands (Intro Call)

12:30–1:00 PM CDT (30 min) | Format/location not on the invite — confirm Teams vs. phone before the call | New contact — no prior 1:1 history

Calibration note: This is a first-time call, sourced from an email introduction — not a sales-sourced lead. Treat as a peer/relationship conversation, not a discovery call for a deal. Do not pitch a solution today.

Who They Are

Field	Detail
Company	OFS Brands (parent of OFS, First Office, Carolina Business Furniture)
Industry	Office & healthcare furniture manufacturing
HQ	Huntingburg, Indiana
Founded	1937
Size	~1,500+ employees
Known tech stack	Workday (HCM), UpKeep (maintenance mgmt), OrgWiki (employee directory)
Email domain	ofs.com

Disambiguation flag: There are two unrelated companies that go by "OFS." This is **OFS Brands**, the Indiana furniture manufacturer — not OFS Fitel/Furukawa, the Georgia-based optical fiber company (ofsoptics.com). Confirmed by domain match and Ryan's title.

Who He Is

Ryan Menke — Chief Strategy Officer, OFS

- BS in Marketing, University of Evansville (1996–1999)
- Based in Huntingburg, IN
- Active YPO member — Chapter Chair / Chapter Learning Officer
- Public-facing: guest on "Being at Work" (HRD Advisory Group) and "Building Brands" (Luminus) podcasts; describes himself as father, husband, outdoorsman, "corporate athlete," conservationist, "furniture nut," obsessively curious
- LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/ryan-menke-56ba778](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ryan-menke-56ba778)

Read on him: As Chief Strategy Officer, he's a strategic thinker by mandate, not a technical or IT buyer. This tracks with the actual reason for the call below — he and David are circling the same question from different angles.

Common Connections

10 mutual connections on LinkedIn. Most relevant: **Beth Wimmer** (CEO, Dallas), **Jason McCann** (CEO, Vari), **Paul Dickerson** (CEO/Board Advisor, YPO Champion), **Mijael "Mike" Attias** (Private Equity/M&A, YPO), **Ahad Ghadimi** (CEO, forums@work, YPO Global One), **Brent Gleeson** (CEO, EXCELR8, Navy

SEAL veteran), **Heidi Raines** (Founder, healthcare tech), **Jack Craven** (Executive Coach). Heavy YPO overlap — good open-line material.

Reason for the Call

Confirmed via email (Rex Miller, "Re: Connecting you with David O'Hara," 2026-07-03 / 2026-07-06):

- **Rex Miller** introduced David and Ryan through the **AI Mastermind group**. Both David and Ryan are also **YPO members**.
- Rex framed Ryan as one of the more strategically curious executives he knows on where AI is taking the workforce and business — someone circling the same idea as David from a different angle: that AI is becoming more of a human-system challenge than a technology one.
- David replied on July 6 with enthusiasm about connecting with "another YPO guy" and offered a Teams call, noting no urgency given summer but wanting to connect in the next few weeks.
- **This is a peer/thought-leadership conversation, not a sales intro or prospect call.** No deal angle, no IT need has surfaced or should be assumed.

Suggested Talking Points / Questions

- What's he seeing at OFS as AI starts touching the workforce — where's it helping, where's it creating friction?
- David's own angle (activating human genius vs. replacing it) as a natural bridge — compare notes on how each is thinking about AI as a human-system challenge, not just a technology one.
- YPO / AI Mastermind common ground — worth trading notes on what's resonating in those circles.
- Open door, no pitch: if a real business need surfaces organically, note it — but this call is not built to surface one.

Landmines / Notes

- Don't lead with technical jargon or a services pitch — this is a peer conversation sourced through Rex Miller, not a sales lead. Treat it that way throughout.
- Match his energy. If a genuine business need for Improving surfaces naturally, capture it — but don't go looking for one.

Open Questions Going In

- No location or video link on the invite — confirm format before 12:30.
- Not yet clear whether this is a one-time YPO/AI Mastermind courtesy call or the start of an ongoing relationship — listen for his tone and follow-up energy rather than assuming either way.
- No confirmed read on whether OFS has any live technology or AI initiative — don't assume there is or isn't one; listen for it.